

Realme 11x 5G

Buy it for the camera

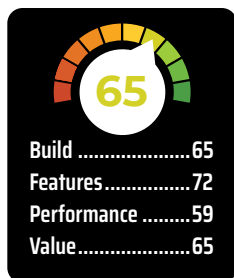
The latest smartphones in Realme's vast portfolio are the Realme 11 5G and its toned-down sibling – the Realme 11x 5G. The 11x5G is situated in the ₹14-16K price bracket in India where Realme doesn't have an overbearing presence, so let's see if it can take on the likes of the Samsung Galaxy M34 5G, and iQOO Z7 5G.

BUILD AND DESIGN

The Realme 11x 5G comes in two colour-ways – Purple Dawn and Midnight Black. I got the former for review and I'd definitely say that the design language is polarising. You either love it or hate it. Now, if you're a fan of subtle and classy designs, you may want to give this one a miss because of how garish it looks. However, the Midnight Black version may still be your cup of tea since it is slightly more muted.

The shimmery back panel is made of glossy plastic and it attracts a fair amount of fingerprints and smudges; although not as much as plain of glossy backs. You've got a large circular camera module on the top left corner of the back panel that houses dual cameras and a flash module. Given the size of the camera module and its placement, the phone rocks considerably when placed on a flat surface. I personally found the phone to be slightly uncomfortable to hold for long periods because of this design trait.

Moving on to buttons and ports, the Realme 11x 5G features volume rockers and a power button on the right side. The buttons are tactile and the power button doubles as a fingerprint sensor. It is accurate and speedy, so props to Realme here. The bottom of the phone houses a USB Type C charging port, a 3.5 mm audio jack, and a single mono speaker. The left side features the SIM tray with slots for two SIM cards and a microSD card.



DISPLAY

The Realme 11x 5G has a pretty basic display for the display. The bezels are uneven – especially the bottom chin bezel which is disproportionately thick. It is a 6.72-inch Full HD+ IPS LCD display with 120 Hz refresh rate support.

I was disappointed to see that Realme hasn't gone for an OLED display here since similarly priced competitors like the iQOO Z7, Samsung Galaxy M34, and Moto G52 all sport AMOLED displays. Add to that, a single mono speaker, and this is definitely not a device I'd recommend for content consumption at this price point. You'd be better off going for any of the devices I mentioned before.

That being said, the display is not bad for an LCD panel. The detail is good enough and it is bright enough at 518 nits of peak brightness, according to our tests. However, the colours lack punch, they feel pretty muted compared to the competition. Additionally, the viewing angles are mediocre, at best. There is no HDR certification, but you do get Widevine L1 support, which

means you can watch HD content on OTT platforms.

PERFORMANCE

The Realme 11x 5G sports MediaTek's new Dimensity 6100+ 5G SoC, just like its more expensive sibling, the Realme 11 5G. It boasts a maximum clock speed of 2.2 GHz and is manufactured on the 6 nm process. The phone comes with 6 or 8 GB of LPDDR4X RAM, with Dynamic RAM Expansion up to 8 GB. However, virtual RAM (dubbed Dynamic RAM by Realme) isn't as powerful as actual RAM. You also get 128 GB of UFS 2.2 storage, alongside the option to expand the memory via microSD card.

The Dimensity 6100+ does a pretty decent job at keeping up with its competitors on phones such as the Samsung Galaxy M34 and iQOO Z7, however, it did come up short in a couple of benchmarks. Starting with AnTuTu and GeekBench, the performance is competitive, but it falls behind in both tests. However, it does pull ahead of the iQOO Z7 in PCMark Work, which means it should be able to handle productivity-based tasks slightly better.

In GPU benchmarks though, the gap is substantial. In both 3D Mark Wild Life and GFXBench tests, the Realme 11x 5G scores almost half as much as the iQOO Z7 and Samsung Galaxy M34. I felt the difference in real-world gaming performance as well, where I could easily play Call of Duty: Mobile on the Samsung Galaxy M34 on High Graphics but the Realme 11x struggled to handle it with consistent frame rates. The Realme 11x performed decently well when gaming on Medium graphics, but go any higher and you'll face some stutters.

I faced a similar issue when it came to multitasking. Despite having 8 GB RAM, plus the option to expand it via virtual RAM, the phone seemed laggy at times – which is bewildering. Especially when booting up and clicking pictures. My bet would be that the phone's processor isn't well-tuned enough so far since it is quite new and Realme's array of third-party apps and bloatware don't really help.

Nevertheless, the performance is adequate for day-to-day tasks; scrolling